Be a Word Architect

Vocabulary Words

acronym
anonymous
antonym
denominator
nameless
namely
namesake
nametag
nominal
nominate
nomination
nominator
pseudonym
rename
synonym

Word Learning Tip!

The words in this lesson all have *name, nomen/nomin,* or *onym* in them. *Nomen* is a root that comes from Latin. It can also be spelled *nomin.* No matter how it is spelled, when you see this root in a word, you know the word tells about names or naming. The root *onym* also means name. It comes from Greek. If you see this root in an unknown word, you will know that the unknown word means something about names or naming.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Word Families When you know the general meaning of a root or smaller word in an unfamiliar word, you can add the meanings of the word parts together to learn the meanings of new words more easily.

Learn More!

You can build many words that tell something about names and naming if you know the word parts *name, nomen/nomin,* and *onym*. *Name* comes from the Old English word *nama.* You can add a prefix to *name*, a suffix, a root, or another word to form new words. You can also add more than one word part. For example, if you want to change your dog's name, you would add the prefix *re-* to *name* to form *rename.*

re + name = rename

Nomen and *nomin* are two different spellings for the root that comes from the Latin word *nomīnāre*, which means "to name." *Onym* is a root that comes from the Greek word *onyma*, meaning name. You can add a prefix, a suffix, a root, or another word to *nomen*, *nomin*, or *onym* to form new words. You can also add more than one word part. For example, if you want to name someone for office, you would add the suffix *-ate* to *nomin* to form *nominate.* If you want to name a word that means the same as another word, you would add the prefix *syn-* to *onym* to form *synonym.*

nomin + ate = nominate
syn + onym = synonym

name	English	name
nomen/nomin	Latin	name
onym	Greek	name

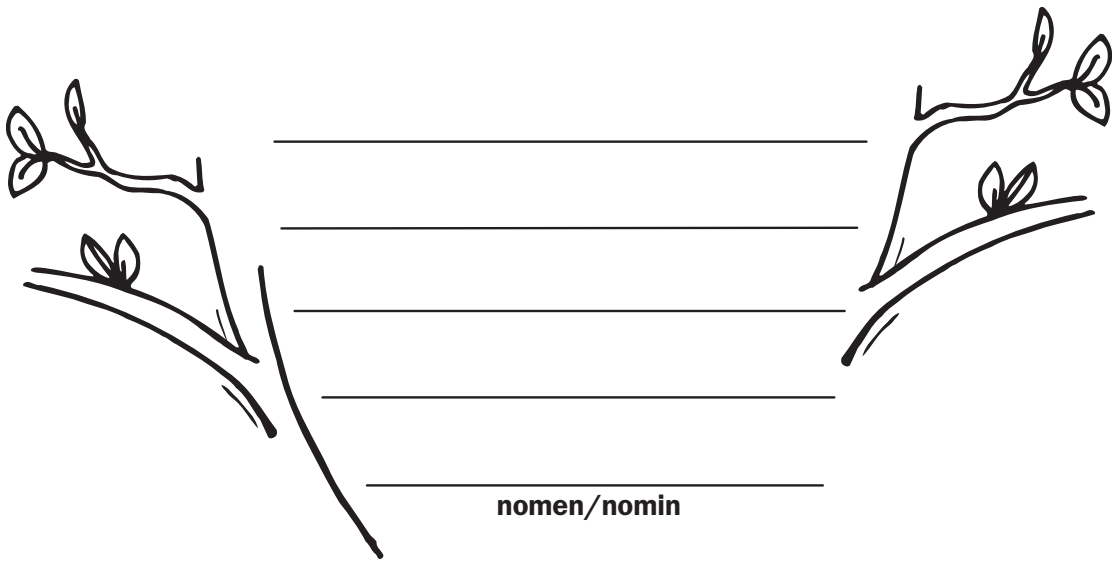
Create a Pseudonym Imagine you want to write a book which keeps people guessing about your identity. Create a pseudonym for yourself. Then write a paragraph telling why you chose this pseudonym. Use as many vocabulary words as you can.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Be a Word Architect

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

Directions Look at each branch of the word family tree below. Place each vocabulary word on the correct branch. Circle the word or word part in each that means "name."





Name, Naming

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Connect Words and Meanings

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

Directions Read each definition. Use the vocabulary word to answer the question that follows it.

1. **pseudonym** a false or made-up name
   Why might an author use a **pseudonym**?

   _____

2. **acronym** a word formed from the first or first few letters of the words in a phrase
   What would be an **acronym** for a group called "Protect Animal Rights Today"?

   _____

3. **nominate** to name someone to do a job, hold an office, or receive an honor
   Who would you **nominate** to win the award for the person whom you admire most? Tell why.

   _____

4. **rename** to give a new name to someone or something
   What would you rename your favorite breakfast cereal? Explain your choice.

   _____

5. **antonym** a word that means the opposite of another word
   If you wanted to use an **antonym** for *bold* to describe a crocodile that was filled with fear, which word would you use?

   _____

6. **nametag** a badge telling the name of the person wearing it
   If you gave a very large party, why might you supply a **nametag** for each person to wear?

   _____

7. **nominal** in name only; very small or slight
   If you pay only a **nominal** fee to attend a carnival, do you pay a lot of money or only a little money?

   _____

8. **nomination** the act or instance of naming or appointing a person to office
   After someone gets the **nomination** for class president, what might that person do next?

   _____

Continued on next page

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Connect More Words and Meanings

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

Directions Continue this activity. Read each definition and answer the question that follows it.

9. **nameless** lacking a name; not able to be described or named
Why might someone who donates money to a charity want to remain **nameless**?

_____

10. **denominator** a trait that two or more people have; the number that is below the line in a fraction that names how many equal parts the whole number can be divided into
What is the common **denominator** between students who belong to a rock-climbing club?

_____

11. **namesake** a person named after another person
What two different nicknames might the **namesake** of Uncle Joseph have?

_____

12. **namely** that is to say; specifically
If you wanted to earn money to buy skates, you would do **namely** what two things?

_____

13. **synonym** a word that means the same or nearly the same as another word
If you were writing about how you felt very tired after staying up late to watch a movie, what **synonym** for *tired* might you use?

_____

14. **anonymous** written or done by a person whose name is not known or made public
Why might the artist who painted a picture hundreds of years ago be **anonymous**?

_____

15. **nominator** a person who names another person to run for office, do a job, or win a prize
What might the **nominator** of a person for president say?

_____

Give a Speech Think about someone you would like to *nominate* for president of your class or a club to which you belong. Why would the person be a good president? Write your ideas in your personal word journal. Then write a nominating speech.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Learn Words in Context

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

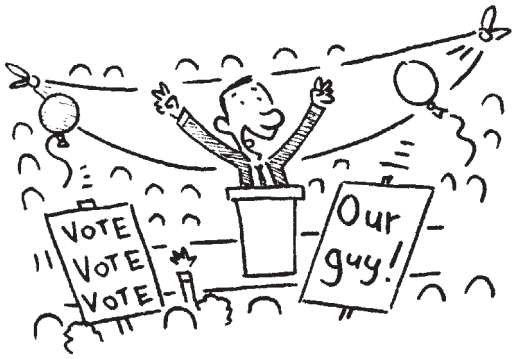
Convention Time

The convention is meeting to **nominate** a candidate for president. The **nominator** is a well-known governor. He takes the stage and makes a speech to name a person to run for office. Then the **nomination** is official. The hall erupts in noise. *Commotion*, *tumult*, and *hubbub* are **synonyms** for the kind of uproar that takes place. Thousands of party members dance in the aisles. They wave banners and bounce balloons. For half an hour or so, the hall might as well be **renamed** Party Central. **Nametags** are worn to give people's names and home states such as, "Ricardo Cisneros, New York," and "Cheryl McCarty, Louisiana." No longer **nameless** workers, their names and faces appear briefly on the television screens of millions of viewers. "That's Cheryl!" folks at home say. Cheryl is famous for a moment—not an **anonymous**, unknown face among hundreds of others.

Carmaleta Cummings, a famous newscaster, is at the convention, reporting on events. She uses a **pseudonym** rather than her real name—Gladys Glowacki. Carmaleta talks above the noisemaking. "Jenna Johnson," she reports," is banging her gavel for quiet. But noise, not its **antonym**, quiet, is all that is heard now.

"Jenna is the **namesake** of her very famous mother, Senator Jenna Jackson," Carmaleta continues. "She is chair of the National Committee and the **nominal**, or "in name only," leader of the party because she's not as powerful as Tony Zaccaro. Everyone knows that she doesn't make the important decisions. Those decisions are made over lunches run by the party's inner circle. This circle includes three people, **namely**, Tony Zaccaro and his best friends Betty O'Leary and Rachel Enriquez. They're popularly known by the **acronym** ZOE, for Zaccaro, O'Leary, and Enriquez. The common **denominator** among all politicians, of course, is their desire to win elections and to serve the public. We see that clearly tonight, here at historic Convention Hall. We'll see it next month in another city when the other party meets.

"And now I turn it back over to you, Joan."



Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Use Words in Context

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

Directions Read the speech. Write the vocabulary word that best fits in each blank.

My fellow Americans, it is with great pride that I accept your **(1)**_____ for President of the United States. First of all, I would like to thank my **(2)**_____, Senator Lucinda Martini, for her wonderful speech. I hope that if I am ever called upon to **(3)**_____ a candidate before this convention, I will do it as well as she did. Like me, she is a proud patriot and comes from a long line of people who have served their country. Did you know that her grandmother served in the WAC during World War II? That's an **(4)**_____ for the Woman's Army Corps.

Ladies and gentlemen, have you ever realized that the initials of the United States, U.S., form the word *us*? That means each and every one of us. Whether famous like me, or unknown and **(5)**_____ to the public like many Americans, everyone is still important. Even if you're the kind of person whose name no one can remember without looking at your **(6)**_____ or badge, you're still somebody. As my granddaddy, the first Brent Brentson, used to say to me, his **(7)**_____, "The common **(8)**_____ among us all is that we're all human beings." The way I see it, the word *human* is a **(9)**_____ for the words *decent, caring,* and *kind,* and it's the **(10)**_____ of *mean, nasty,* and *evil*. We need a candidate for president who believes in the word *human*. Namely, we need me, Brent Brentson! Thank you very much.



Design a Campaign Slogan On a separate sheet of paper, design a slogan and poster to elect Brent Brentson. Include at least three vocabulary words in your design.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Review and Extend

acronym	**denominator**	**namesake**	**nominate**	**pseudonym**
anonymous	**nameless**	**nametag**	**nomination**	**rename**
antonym	**namely**	**nominal**	**nominator**	**synonym**

Directions Answer each question below by writing a sentence using one vocabulary word. Underline the vocabulary word that you use.

1. You want to become a famous actor, and you decide your name is too ordinary. You want a more memorable name. What can you do?

   _____

2. *Wet*, *damp*, and *humid* are three words that have related meanings. If you wanted to find another related word, why would you use a thesaurus or a dictionary.?

   _____

3. You write a poem, but you don't want to publish under your own name. What kind of name would you put at the top of the poem?

   _____

4. You form a club called the Friends of Everybody. Later, you realize that your club's initials spell the word FOE. How do you feel about this?

   _____

Directions Here are some other words that have *name* or *nomin* in them. First, try to determine their meaning. Check your guess in a dictionary. Then use each word in a sentence.

New Words

unnameable	**renominate**	**namedrop**	**nameplate**

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

Interview a Candidate Work with a partner. Think about issues that are important to you, and jot them down in your personal word journal. Then write two questions to ask a presidential or senatorial candidate. Try to use at least three vocabulary words. Take turns reading and playing the roles of a news reporter and a candidate.

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources

Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1. Melanie proposed Jack's name as a candidate for secretary of the book club. Melanie is Jack's _____.
A. nominate **B.** nominator **C.** nomination **D.** denominator

2. The names of the artists who painted prehistoric cave paintings are unknown. These artists are _____.
A. namely **B.** pseudonym **C.** anonymous **D.** acronym

3. An antonym of the word *true* is the word _____.
A. *honest* **B.** *broken* **C.** *inside* **D.** *false*

4. A synonym of the word *pretty* is the word _____.
A. *beautiful* **B.** *ugly* **C.** *plain* **D.** *simple*

5. Which of the following has a name written on it?
A. nameless **B.** rename **C.** nametag **D.** namely

6. Everyone in the community agreed to give the street a new name to honor Louis Armstrong. Which of the following words describes what the community did?
A. rename **B.** namely **C.** nominal **D.** anonymous

7. Which of the following is an acronym for the National Football League?
A. Nat. Ft. Le. **B.** the League **C.** NBA **D.** NFL

8. Dr. Ernesto Brughman named his son Ernesto. Brughman's son is his _____.
A. nomination **B.** nametag **C.** nominator **D.** namesake

9. Which of the following terms has the number 4 as a denominator?
A. 1/4 **B.** 4 **C.** 4/5 **D.** 4.4

10. You may never have heard of the writer Samuel Langhorne Clemens because you may know him as Mark Twain. "Mark Twain" is his _____.
A. nametag **B.** pseudonym **C.** nominator **D.** anonymous

Powerful Vocabulary for Reading Success: Grade 5 © Scholastic Teaching Resources